ADVENTURER GUIDE TO PERSONAL GROWTH

Satisfy your inner free spirit while building a fulfilling life rich with adventure

16Personalities

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Introduction

Why Personal Growth Matters to Adventurers

Personal growth isn't the one-size-fits-all affair that some self-help books would have us believe. It's really about expanding beyond comfort and habit to explore new ways of existing. For Adventurers, personal growth is always about balancing spontaneity with responsibility, independence with intimacy, and desire for novelty with appreciation for things as they are. The goal is never about changing individual Adventurers' essential personalities but expanding themselves to include a greater array of tools for getting through their lives more skillfully.

For Adventurers to grow, they must first develop self-awareness, assessing themselves and their behaviors. Are their behaviors pleasant in the moment but harmful in the long run? What do they want from life, both now and in the future? This thinking need not box Adventurers into rigid plans – considering the future can open up new, more fulfilling possibilities.

But truly achieving personal growth involves replacing unhealthy behaviors with new behaviors that bring Adventurers closer to what they want in life.

It's worth noting that not all growth is the product of deliberate effort. Sometimes it emerges gently from the subtle shifts caused by age and maturity, and sometimes life harshly demands growth through hard times and crises. No matter the method, as the saying goes, "You're either getting better, or you're getting worse. There is no staying the same."

No matter what life throws at them, Adventurers have the innate advantage of being both flexible and adaptable. These traits are critical for being able to compassionately recognize the behaviors and habits that hold them back, while simultaneously exploring new ways of moving forward.

But Adventurers are also free spirits who resist rules, routines, guidelines, and imposed structures. Alas, this pursuit of independence and enjoyment can lead these types to ignore important practical matters, like the needs of other people. It can also lead to taking unnecessary risks and neglecting to plan for the future. Admittedly, it can be overwhelming to start working on personal growth – it's a challenge to look at oneself, not only on the inside but also at interactions with others and the world at large. It can be difficult to know where to start.

Personal growth feels less intimidating when contemplated by its parts, rather than as an all-encompassing whole. That is why this book is organized around the three distinct areas of personal growth that Adventurers will want to consider as they develop and strengthen their self-regard.

The Three Areas of Personal Growth

- **Self-esteem** speaks to how much Adventurers like themselves. Accepting both their flaws and strengths creates a base of internal appreciation that enables change motivated by desire instead of shame.
- **Self-respect** speaks to their sense of worth. People with this personality type value empathy and harmony, and when they live their beliefs and values, a balanced sense of pride in who they are follows.
- **Self-confidence** is the energy source that moves Adventurers forward in life. When belief in their abilities is confirmed using their skills, Adventurers are driven to make steady progress.

If these three core aspects are properly balanced and nurtured, they can promote a successful and fulfilling life. If these elements become unbalanced, however, they become a source of overwhelming difficulty. For example, when Adventurers feel a lack of self-confidence, they might compensate with behaviors that give them a boost – but problems arise should they overcompensate and throw their lives out of balance.

Moving Forward

Conscious personal growth is about more than feeling obligated to change. When inspired, these types seek new ways to be happier and more successful – including an independent and personal definition of success. The goal is to spur their inner drive with ideas, encouragement, and gentle guidance for possible problems along the way.

In this e-book, we'll examine these three aspects of personal growth, specifically as they relate to Adventurers' characteristics in their ideal, balanced, and developed form.

Next, we'll describe the tendencies that emerge if these aspects become unbalanced. These represent departures from healthy, productive strategies and explain adverse effects that Adventurers experience when they disconnect from their true selves. Finally, we'll discuss what can be done to improve balance in each of these aspects.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

Self-Esteem

It's common for sensitive people to struggle to reconcile emotion and memory with their logic. Yet Adventurers who maintain firm connections to their sense of emotional harmony also create strength in the higher functions of their beings. Internal conflict inhibits happy and inspired lives, while self-appreciation is a state from which all good things can grow.

Balanced Self-Esteem

A sense of competence and mastery drives Adventurers' self-esteem engine. These types never want to settle for "good enough." Combining their natural curiosity, their extraordinary perception, and their creative edge, life beckons Adventurers to discover how far a scenario can go. This naturally leads to mastery of a skill or a situation. Without this sense of mastery, people with this personality type are likely to feel a lack of completeness.

Even if they do something well, unless they feel like they've done it expertly, Adventurers may feel like they haven't met their potential. They tend to strive to take any skill or achievement, large or small, to the next level until they can perfect it no further. This driving motivation can be an employer's dream come true. Adventurers accept the challenge of any problem, do the job, and do it correctly to completion.

Unbalanced Self-Esteem

Is there such a thing as too much mastery? Not exactly. But Adventurers must decide if the intense focus it takes to develop expertise is worth certain sacrifices when all is said and done. With their desire to dominate any fields they enter or any problems they seek to solve, Adventurers may not consider any collateral damage that others may face because of their search for perfection.

Sometimes Adventurers must choose between focusing on their goals and caring for the needs of others. When this happens, they inevitably place others further down on their list of priorities. They don't do this because they dislike people. They try to be kind and useful to others,

and they may even regard themselves as "people persons," despite being Introverted. And they are – but they can see others as "getting in their way" when they're working hard to master something. This is especially difficult if they feel it's a boss or other decision-maker who's in the way. In extreme cases, Adventurers might achieve the mastery they crave but lose other valuable aspects of their lives – like jobs and relationships – in the process.

Rebalancing Self-Esteem

Adventurers must try to grasp the big picture to moderate an overblown need for mastery that can quickly turn into an obsession. A view of the overall picture can show Adventurers that sacrificing dependability and relationships for personal accomplishment and expertise does more harm than good in the end. Sometimes the long view must take priority over other, more immediate impulses, even the best of them.

Many philosophers throughout time have said in different ways what the philosopher Voltaire penned, "The best is the enemy of the good." Adventurers would do well to stop and consider this. Instead of obsessing over the things they can master, sometimes they must subordinate this desire to a larger goal that's "good enough" and fosters teamwork and relationship building instead. Perhaps, to balance their self-esteem, they should master working with others.

Self-Respect

For Adventurers, self-respect comes from their ability to think on their feet and solve problems on almost an improvisational level. Their self-respect doesn't involve deep deliberation. They prefer the action required in assessing a situation and providing a hands-on solution. It doesn't matter which discipline they master – the dynamic is the same. They like to think of themselves as individuals who can manipulate the different parts of their specialty to provide results.

Balanced Self-Respect

Adventurers like themselves when they feel they're flexible and able to deal skillfully with unexpected things that come at them. "Steady as she goes" brings no sense of fulfilment to this type, because they assess themselves by how well they can troubleshoot. In striving for self-respect, Adventurers hone and exercise their skill at handling sudden predicaments.

While most types like some measure of stability, Adventurers find no satisfaction in staying on metaphorical solid ground. They feel better about themselves after they've navigated choppy waters and figured out how to keep the boat upright. To mix metaphors, successfully negotiating twisting trails beats traveling the straight and narrow highway every time. There's no sense of accomplishment for them in sitting around being content.

Because of this, there's nothing like having Adventurers around during a crisis – and Adventurers never feel better about themselves than when they're effectively dealing with one. If there's an emergency, find Adventurers. They'll take care of the situation and gain a feeling of fulfillment simultaneously. They must know they have the skills and flexibility to take care of such matters to respect themselves.

Unbalanced Self-Respect

The most significant problem people with the Adventurer personality type can face is that everybody else in the world isn't an Adventurer. To increase their self-respect, some Adventurers may resort to seeking difficulties to conquer or taking risks just to prove their worth to themselves. While they continue to look for problems to solve and

things to master, family, friends and coworkers may not be so interested in constantly facing down difficulties to show their skills. Most other people like to avoid problems and don't find overcoming challenges as stimulating as Adventurers do.

Others may come to see Adventurers as careless, unstable, undependable, or, at times, even dangerous. In a social or work setting, this can cause a lot of disharmony. To make these conflicts even worse, Adventurers may not care that much about the opinions of others when they find themselves on a mission. Think of Don Draper on the TV series Mad Men and the unpopular, bold risks he frequently took to solve problems at his advertising agency. Such disregard for friends, business associates, and loved ones can be damaging.

When this motivational source is out of balance, Adventurers may like themselves as they solve problems, but they may also find that others aren't so enamored with them. Adventurers should try to understand boosting their self-respect at the expense of others may make their lives less than satisfying when all is said and done.

Rebalancing Self-Respect

"Reframing" is a psychological trick we can play on ourselves to create a new attitude or encourage a new behavior. When we reframe, we shift our perspective, and this helps to help us respond to things differently.

Adventurers who have run roughshod over other people while overzealously trying to solve problems, create solutions, or master skills can instead try to reframe their social or business networks as other puzzles they need to solve. They can see each unhappy person in their social constellation as a challenge.

If a spouse or friend is upset, what can these types do to make their world better? If the boss is unhappy with their too narrow focus, what can Adventurers do to solve the "boss problem?" These are all worthy challenges for Adventurers who think about them that way. Therapists and counselors can help Adventurers reframe these behaviors, but these types tend to want to develop their people skills in their own ways.

Self-Confidence

While it might sound circular, Adventurers gain confidence when they act in confident ways. With their bold actions, they send a message to themselves that they're on the right track and can move forward even more confidently. That their chosen action is bold is often the only sign of success they need. Trying new and different things drives the Adventurers' self-confidence.

Balanced Self-Confidence

Many credit the German writer and statesman Goethe with saying, "Boldness has genius, power and magic in it. Begin it now." This quotation is music to the ears of Adventurers. A sense of bold self-assurance gives them the thrust they need to move forward in life. They tend to have little regard for traditional standards or rules because they're too confining and limit the Adventurers' creative imagination.

Boldly finding new places to be (metaphorically or literally) and new ways to do things pull Adventurers confidently into the future. The "next new thing" energizes them. They're likely to love change where others dread it. Attraction to bold innovation and problem-solving is what gives them energy and confidence.

Unbalanced Self-Confidence

We admire boldness in our culture. Our heroes are those who are audacious and act in bigger-than-life ways. However, when the need to feel confident becomes so strong that Adventurers act boldly simply for its own sake, it can be damaging.

Such daring action can become disconnected from anything that's meaningful, such as business plans, security, and the things that make others feel secure and confident. This can detach Adventurers from their social or career networks. While they move forward with great bluster, those around them might simply shake their heads at what they can only see as erratic behavior.

Rebalancing Self-Confidence

Mission statements that describe the vision of organizations or individuals have become a staple for goal-setting and self-improvement. Adventurers would do well to spend a little time expanding their comfort zone and creating their own mission statements.

They also may want to review the mission statement of any organization to which they belong. While they can consider putting their own intrepid spin on them, such statements can help them stay in touch with what's relevant and important. Maps like these can help these types remain on the road to relevant outcomes even when their need to express their boldness is urging them to veer off it. This counter-balance to their Prospecting nature may help them stay in touch with the bigger picture and the needs and goals of others.

Pursuing Personal Growth

Adventurers are well-equipped to take on the challenge of developing balanced self-esteem, self-respect, and self-confidence. They find meaning and purpose in the act of seeking and discovering those subtle (or not-so-subtle) shifts that bring about immediate, productive results. They hone their very lives to be fine and effective tools in their natural and preferred process of personal growth and self-refinement.

But Adventurers will also benefit from developing the less instinctual – and more challenging – practice of stopping long enough to thoughtfully plan and create consistency in their lives. This includes taking the time to see how other people are doing in the midst of their flurry of activity. Checking in with others is an important part of personal growth and can bring Adventurers deeper satisfaction and happiness as they figure out how to comfortably fit others into their lives while still going after their personal goals.

In the end, it's helpful for Adventurers to remember that life is a skill. Personal growth is a skill. This means that it involves skill-building and constant tinkering to find what works. It's something to polish. Developing their lives and attaining personal growth fits with Adventurers' foundational skill set perfectly.

What is that foundational skill set? And how else can Adventurers harness their natural strengths for the sake of personal growth? What downsides might these traits harbor without the moderating factor of self-awareness?

Making Good Use of Adventurer Traits

Excellent Improvisers

The most impressive trait of all is Adventurers' ability to "think on their feet" – people with this personality type can make snap decisions and can seemingly always escape even the most challenging situations. This makes them excellent improvisers, especially where there's a need to act quickly and come up with an idea without prior planning. Adventurers are fiercely utilitarian, willing to do what it takes to do the job, even if it means breaking with existing traditions – although this is also accompanied by their kind attitude toward other people. This

approach may not win them many friends among the more cooperative and stability-oriented types (usually Diplomats or Sentinels), but it's likely to give them the reputation of being highly effective artisans, whatever their crafts may be.

However, Adventurers should pay attention to their tendency to focus on their primary goal and leave all other tasks aside – this attitude allows them to move quickly but poses a danger to their legacy once the main task is finished. Other people, especially those opposed to Adventurers' "Let's get this done!" attitude, may often point fingers at all the little things left unfinished or procedures overlooked, ignoring Adventurers' main achievements. These types are at their best when they're paired with others who can sort out the logistics behind the operation – Adventurers tend to be brilliant artists and improvisers, but mediocre administrators or logisticians.

Adventurers are bold and able to both notice and act on opportunities that other types can't or don't want to. People with this personality type shouldn't be reluctant to embrace their spontaneity if the circumstances are right – they're well-equipped to deal with unexpected challenges and succeed with scarce resources. Adventurers can excel in the most unfavorable environments, knowing exactly how far they can push limits, what tactics they can pursue, and which resources they can employ.

Clever and Artistic

Adventurers are known for their cleverness, ingenuity, and artistic skills. The term "artist" can mean many things when talking about them – many are artists in the true sense of the word, but some also use their excellent grasp of the real world in other areas. There's no other personality type as adept at noticing what is likely to excite our senses – Adventurers can easily become masters of sound, color, flavor, design etc. This peculiar trait usually makes these types very creative and productive individuals, especially once they get enough freedom to follow their own paths.

Once they find a niche that's right for them, they can then follow their instincts instead of listening to critics and naysayers. To paraphrase playwright George Bernard Shaw, "The careful man adapts himself to the world; the reckless one persists in trying to adapt the world

to himself. Therefore, all progress depends on the reckless man." It's important for Adventurers to know their limitations, while not being afraid to capitalize on their strengths – no other personality type knows how to enjoy the present moment as much as they do, and no one should underestimate the importance of their skills.

Unpredictable and Exciting

Adventurers' boldness and thirst for adrenaline are also likely to be very attractive to other people, including potential romantic partners. Just like many other things in their lives, Adventurers' relationships are full of both excitement and unpredictability, as they're able to find something interesting to do and to keep the flames of romance burning brightly.

However, Adventurers often avoid committing to anything or anyone. Knowing full well that life is unpredictable, they're likely to live in the present instead of planning for the future. Many Adventurers are happy with this approach – after all, "Seize the day!" is their motto – but it's important to remember that many other people expect them to commit to their relationships relatively early and may get hurt if their Adventurer lovers don't seem that interested.

People with this personality type don't need to worry too much about attracting partners as it's likely their partners will find them instead – however, Adventurers may need to work on recognizing (and, if necessary, managing) their partners' expectations if they want to have strong, lasting relationships. The same principles apply to non-romantic relationships as well – other people may be surprised by their unwillingness to settle down and stop wandering.

What Causes Most Problems for Adventurers?

Impulsive Thrill-Seeking

Adventurers often enjoy giving in to their impulses and desires so much that the line between what is acceptable and what isn't can quickly become blurry – which has very real repercussions in the practical realm but can be especially problematic when it comes to self-esteem, self-respect, and self-confidence.

Deeply utilitarian at heart, Adventurers are unlikely to worry too much about this, but it's essential to know their limits and not be too selfish or hurt anyone else – otherwise, people with this personality type can be in danger of drifting toward purely sensual or even antisocial activities. Adventurers have the potential to achieve balance in all three areas of personal growth, but to achieve that, they must learn how to occasionally rein in their spontaneity.

Adventurers have a sensation-seeking disposition and are fascinated by things they can experience with their five senses. Abstract, theoretical matters don't interest them as much – people with this personality type seek sensual rather than mental stimulation. They're also one of the most impulsive and hot-blooded types, cherishing variety and unpredictability.

Sometimes, they may even come up with artificial challenges or issues just to liven up the environment – Adventurers can't stand boredom and routine. However, it's important to keep this predisposition in check. Otherwise, Adventurers may find themselves in a downward spiral of taking ever greater risks and seeking ever stronger sensations, all in the name of thrill and variety.

This can be especially destructive in romantic relationships – their lovers can either get stressed out because of increasing instability or join their Adventurer partners, encouraging and enabling their adrenaline-seeking behavior.

Overly Optimistic

Adventurers tend to be overly optimistic and, sometimes, even careless. They want to have fun, to enjoy the moment, and to experience everything there is to experience – and they're used to close brushes with danger, always saved by their highly developed observational skills and willingness to do everything and anything to achieve their desired goals.

However, even Adventurers sometimes run out of luck, and there ceases to be a balance between their self-confidence and self-doubt. People with this personality type often find it difficult to resist the urge to jump in first and ask questions later, but it's important to learn to put everything in perspective.

It's their optimism and belief in their abilities that allow Adventurers to notice and take advantage of various opportunities. However, such traits may also push them to make rash and misinformed decisions, especially if they lack experience in specific areas. Adventurers should try to join forces with others who are more meticulous and disciplined, as such partnerships allow their strengths to flourish.

Rejecting Rational Thinking

Adventurers may also want to pay more attention to their rational thinking skills. People with this personality type tend to dislike abstract, theoretical discussions, and do their best to escape such situations – or pretend they're interested while their minds are elsewhere. Adventurers are no-nonsense people, always keeping their feet on the ground, and while this is a great trait when it comes to entrepreneurship and professional goals, it's also important to learn to challenge their urges and instincts, and instead force all important decisions to pass through their rational filter.

If such skills are left underdeveloped, Adventurers may eventually end up with a bag of mistakes, often blaming other people for their own missteps. Focusing on what's fun while avoiding what's uncomfortable or difficult isn't conducive to personal growth.

Struggling with Social Skills

Adventurers' personality traits (especially their Introversion) can make it difficult for people with this personality type to engage in small talk and may lead to awkwardness in social situations, especially if others aren't willing to take the lead. Adventurers may often experience anxiety well before social events, knowing they're likely to be challenging. Being highly practical and observant, these types are more suited to handle such situations compared to Intuitive types, but this doesn't mean they'll feel comfortable.

This discomfort with certain social interactions can result in Adventurers becoming highly vulnerable to emotional manipulation. People with this personality type should be aware of this danger and keep an eye out for potential manipulation attempts. Adventurers tend to be very kind and friendly, but their good nature may be abused by less scrupulous individuals.

Final Words

The problems described above need not debilitate Adventurers. Similar to the way they solve design problems, finding the right ways to overcome these types of personality hurdles may only require a bit of inspired attention and mindfulness.

With their creative, sometimes artistic perspectives, Adventurers seek to apply a fresh spin to ideas that they're passionate about, and this includes personal growth. Living life believing that each moment is an exciting opportunity to create something new overwhelmingly provides the wind for their sails.

While their impulsiveness and unique perspectives can come across as unpredictable and unconventional to people who don't know them well, Adventurers are kind and sensitive to the needs of friends and strangers – especially those who enjoy their spontaneity and their sometimes quirky take on things. Adventurers' imaginative and independent impulses often involve risk and, consequently, invite criticism that can shake their confidence and self-esteem. And this may be the challenge of their lives: *to be true to themselves while not allowing themselves to be undermined by the opinions of others.*

As Introverts, Adventurers are often sensitive and easily stressed. They'll frequently need solitary time to recharge, evaluate their direction, and regroup. These moments are when the work of personal growth is done. By putting in place the structures that allow them to find balance, Adventurers can satisfy their lust for life – setting trends, embracing new opportunities, and exploring the breathtaking beauty and pleasures of the world.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you direct your personal growth journey? Explore our Personal Growth Specialized Tests.
- Looking to enhance your academic or professional life? Check out the *Adventurer Guide to Careers*.
- Feeling adrift when it comes to your romantic relationships, friendships, or relationships with your children? Our *Adventurer Guide to Relationships* may be just what you need.

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